# ARES Simplex Test: Who Can I Hear?

Member guide - RARC ARES net, Olmsted County, Minnesota

**Your map page:**
**https://d-donovan.github.io/ares-simplex/**
Net control will read the address out on the net. Open it on your phone, tablet or computer.

## What this is

If the repeater goes down, ARES stations will talk to each other directly on simplex. This test shows **how well you can hear the other stations from your own QTH**, with your own radio and antenna. Net control simply gets everyone transmitting on simplex, one after another. You listen, write down who you hear on this page, and it plots them on **your own map**. Nothing you enter is sent to anyone else.

## Before the test (once, takes a minute)

1. Open the page. Under **1. My station**, type your callsign with its SSID, for example **W0ABC-7**, and press Enter.
2. The page finds your latest position on aprs.fi, **centers the map on your QTH**, and shows a purple **YOU** marker.
3. **No APRS?** Type your 6-character grid square (for example **EN34ra**) or **latitude,longitude**. The page then asks for your callsign too. Type it and press Set again.
4. Your station is remembered in your browser, so next time it is already set.

## During the test

1. Join the net as usual (Sundays, 9 PM Central, 146.820 repeater).
2. When net control announces the test, switch to the **simplex frequency** they give you and **stay in listen mode**. Net control will call stations to transmit one at a time. Use the antenna and power you would really have in an emergency. An HT is fine.
3. When you hear a station, type its callsign under **2. Station I hear on simplex**. Choose **Copy well** or **Weak / partial**, and press **Enter** (or **Add to my map & clear**).
4. The page looks up the station's position on aprs.fi, plots it on your map with a line to you, and clears the box ready for the next callsign.
5. When it is your turn, transmit your callsign so others can log you.
6. **Station with no APRS?** If you know its grid square (4, 6 or 8 characters, for example **EN34ra**), type it in the **Grid** box before pressing Enter. The page then skips the aprs.fi lookup. A 6- or 8-character grid is best; a 4-character grid is only accurate to about 70 miles. Grid-based dots are

shown with a **dashed outline** and a **~** in the list, because they are approximate. If a lookup finds nothing, the Grid box turns red and the page asks you to fill it in.

**Tip:** you do not have to type fast. Write callsigns on paper while listening and enter them afterwards. The page and your list stay on your device.

## Reading your map

| | |
|---|---|
| 🟢 **Green, solid line** | Stations you copied well. |
| 🟡 **Yellow, dashed line** | Stations you heard only weakly or partly. |
| ◌ **Dashed outline** | Approximate position (from a grid square you typed). |
| **YOU** (purple) | Your own station. |
| Thick outline | Olmsted County. |

Each station shows its **distance from you** on the map. The list gives distance and direction, nearest first, and a summary line such as **"7 stations heard. Farthest: W0XYZ-7, 12.4 mi NE."** Tap a dot for details. Stations you did **not** hear simply do not appear, so gaps on the map show where simplex does not reach you.

## Print or save your map

Press **Print my map**. You get a map showing your QTH and every station you heard, a heading with your callsign, the date and the summary, plus the list with distances. To keep the colors, tick **Background graphics** in the print dialog, or choose **Save as PDF**. It makes a good record for your emergency notes.

## About positions and privacy

- Your station and your list are stored **only in your own browser**. Net control and other members cannot see them.
- Station positions come from **aprs.fi**, the same public APRS data anyone can look up. A station that does not send APRS has no position unless you enter a grid.
- Use **Clear my list** to start fresh for the next test.

**If the page will not load** or says it cannot reach the server, check your internet connection and reload. The radio test does not depend on the website. You can write down what you hear and enter it later.

Position data courtesy of aprs.fi (https://aprs.fi). Map © OpenStreetMap contributors.